Setting up RG-Present

Everything from opening the installer to running your first service: written for a volunteer who has not seen the program before, and short enough to read on a Saturday afternoon.

For RG-Present on Windows 10 and 11. Keep a printed copy beside the church laptop.

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1. What you need

- **A Windows laptop or desktop**, Windows 10 or 11, 64-bit.
- **4 GB of memory** or more. Built-in Intel graphics are fine.
- **A projector or television** connected by HDMI. This is the screen the congregation sees.
- **About 400 MB of free disk**, plus room for your own pictures and video.
- **An internet connection once**, to download the installer. After that RG-Present works with no internet at all.

2. Installing it

1. Go to the download page and choose **Download the installer**. The file is called **RG-Present-Setup.exe** and is about 120 MB.
2. Open it from your Downloads folder.
3. Windows shows a blue box saying **"Windows protected your PC"**. This is not a virus warning. It appears because the installer is not signed with a paid certificate yet. Click **More info**, then **Run anyway**.
4. Choose where to install it. The suggested folder suits almost everyone. Installation takes about a minute.
5. RG-Present opens with 3,648 hymns and the King James Version already in it. There is nothing else to download.

If your church machine blocks installers, you can install the same program from the **Microsoft Store** instead — it is signed by Microsoft and shows no warning. The download page has the link.

Installing without internet at the church

Download the installer somewhere that has a connection, copy it onto a flash drive, and run it on the church machine. Everything RG-Present needs is inside that one file.

3. Connecting the projector

1. Plug the projector or TV into the laptop with an HDMI cable and switch it on.
2. Press <kbd>Windows</kbd> + <kbd>P</kbd> on the keyboard.
3. Choose **Extend**. This is the important one. **Duplicate** puts your own desktop on the wall, which is exactly what we are trying to avoid.

With **Extend**, Windows treats the projector as a second screen. RG-Present puts the slides there and keeps all its controls on your laptop screen.

4. The first five minutes

1. Open RG-Present. The first thing to press is **Output**, at the top right. The dot beside it turns green and the slides appear on the projector.
2. If the slides land on the wrong screen, open **Settings** and set **Audience output screen** to the projector by name. RG-Present remembers this.
3. In the library at the bottom, type part of a hymn you know into the search box and **double-click it**. It goes straight onto the projector. That is the quickest thing the program does, and the one worth practising.
4. Press `Space` for the next verse, `B` to black the screen, and `B` again to bring it back.
5. Put your church logo on the screen between items: add the picture under **Media**, then choose it in **Settings** as the **Logo screen**. From then on `L` shows it.

5. The screen in front of you

The window has four parts, left to right and top to bottom.

PART	WHAT IT IS FOR
Service	The order of the morning, top to bottom. Hymns, readings, notices, videos and headings. Drag the lines to reorder them.
Preview	What you are getting ready. Nothing here is on the projector. Click a slide to choose it, then press **Go Live**.
Live	What the congregation can see right now, inside a red frame, with the controls for it underneath.
Library	Everything you can draw on: Songs, Scripture, Media, Presentations and your saved services.

The dividing lines between the panels can be dragged if you want more room for one of them, and RG-Present remembers where you left them.

Red always means live. If something has a red frame or a red dot, the congregation is looking at it.

6. Building a service

You do not have to build a service to use RG-Present — double-clicking things in the library works all morning. But a service saves repeating yourself, and lets somebody else run the desk.

1. **Add the hymns.** Find each one in the library and drag it into the Service panel, or select it and press **Add to service**.

2. **Add the readings.** On the Scripture tab, choose the book, the chapter and the verses, then drag the reading into the service.
3. **Name the lines the way your church does.** Click the pencil on a line and call it *First reading*, *Offertory*, *Sermon*. The name is yours; the content underneath does not change.
4. **Group them under headings.** The folder button at the top of the Service panel adds a heading — Gathering, The Word, Sending out. Click a heading to fold everything under it out of the way.
5. **Add the other bits.** The three small buttons beside it add a text or announcement slide, a picture or video, and a countdown to the start of the service.
6. **Leave notes for the people at the front.** The note button on a line takes a line such as “Key of G, two verses only”. It appears on the stage display and never on the projector.
7. **Save it** with Ctrl + S, and give it the date. It is then under **Saved services** for next time. Ctrl + P prints the order for the people leading.

Files dropped onto the Service panel from Windows Explorer — pictures, videos, PowerPoints, PDFs — are brought in and added where you dropped them.

7. Running the service

Two habits make Sunday calm:

- **Cue in Preview, then Go Live.** Click the next item while the current one is still on the screen. Nothing you do in Preview can reach the projector.
- **Double-tap when you are caught out.** If the preacher names a verse you were not expecting, find it and double-tap: it goes on the screen immediately and does not change your service.

BUTTON	WHAT IT DOES
Go Live	Sends what is in Preview to the projector.
‹ and ›	Previous and next slide. Space also moves on.
Black	Takes the screen to black. Nothing is lost; press it again to come back.
Clear	Takes the words away and leaves the background. Useful during prayer.
Logo	Shows your church logo or picture, set in Settings.
Message	Puts a line of text across the screen — a car to move, a child to collect — over whatever is already there.

BUTTON	WHAT IT DOES
Read on	Appears during a reading. Carries on into the next verses, and on into the next chapter, without going back to the library.
A− / A+	Makes the words on the projector smaller or bigger, there and then. The percentage between them puts it back to 100%.
Auto	Moves on by itself every few seconds — for a set of notices before the service starts. The box beside it is the number of seconds.
Fade / Slow fade / Cut	How one slide becomes the next.

When a video is live, its own controls appear: pause, sound on or off, and whether it plays again when it ends.

8. Readings

There are three ways to find a passage, and all of them end up in the same place.

- **Type the reference** into the search box on the Scripture tab: **John 3:16-18**, **jn 3 16**, **Ps 23**, **1 cor 13**.
- **Pick it from the lists**: the book down the left, then the chapter, then the verses. Tap one verse, or drag down the list for a range.
- **Search for words** you remember, and RG-Present finds the verses that contain them.

Double-tap a verse and it is on the screen. Drag the passage into the Service panel to keep it for Sunday.

A reading goes up one verse at a time by default, with the reference big enough to read from the back. Settings changes that to two, three, four verses, or as many as the slide will hold.

Two translations at once

The second picker on the Scripture tab puts another translation on the same slide, underneath the first — for a congregation that reads in two languages.

Adding a translation your church is licensed to use

Only public-domain Bibles are shipped with RG-Present, so a translation your church has bought or holds a licence for is one you add yourself: **Settings → Import Bible...**, from an XML, OSIS, JSON, CSV, TSV or plain text file. It then appears beside the King James Version everywhere.

9. The stage display

If you have a third screen — a television facing the musicians, or a tablet — press **Stage** at the top right. It shows the slide that is live, the one coming next, a clock, and any notes you left on that line of the service.

Choose which screen it uses under **Settings → Stage display screen**. Nothing on the stage display ever reaches the congregation.

10. Your own songs

Typing one in

The **+** beside the search box opens a blank song. Give it a title, a number if your church uses them, and type the verses. A blank line starts a new slide, and words such as *Chorus* or *Verse 2* on a line of their own are recognised as labels.

Styling single words

While editing a song, select a word or a line and use the small bar above the box to make it bold or italic, change its colour, its font or its size. Everything else on the slide keeps the theme. It is meant for a refrain in another language, or a line that should stand out — not for decorating a whole hymn.

Importing a folder of songs

Import in the top bar reads TXT, CSV, Word (.docx) and PowerPoint (.pptx) files. RG-Present shows you what it found before anything is added, so you can fix a title or drop a file that came in wrong. Words that mean “chorus” in your language can be added under Settings, so they are picked out properly.

11. Pictures, video and PowerPoint

The **Media** tab holds your pictures, videos and music. **Add images or videos** brings files in; so does dragging them from Explorer. A picture or video fills the projector edge to edge, whatever shape it is — there are no black bars down the sides.

The **Presentations** tab takes a PowerPoint or a PDF and keeps each slide as a picture. That matters: the deck still shows on Sunday after the laptop it was made on has gone home, and it needs no copy of PowerPoint. Drag it into the service like anything else.

12. Themes and backgrounds

A **theme** is the look of a slide: the font, the size, the colour, where the words sit, the shadow behind them and the background. **Themes** in the top bar makes new ones and edits the ones you have.

- Give **scripture its own theme** under Settings, so a reading never looks like a hymn.
- Give **one item its own background** with the picture button at the top of the Preview panel — a photograph behind the closing hymn, say.
- Keep the words readable. White on a dark picture carries to the back of a hall; grey on a bright one does not.

13. Music

Music files added under Media can be played from there — something quiet before the service, or under the notices. While it plays, a small music bar appears under the live controls with pause, loop, volume and stop.

By default the music fades out as soon as something goes on the screen, which is usually what you want. Turn that off in Settings if you would rather it carried on.

14. The web browser

Web in the top bar (or Ctrl + Shift + W) opens a browser in a window of its own, on your screen — never on the projector. Search or type an address. When you want the congregation to see the page, put it on the screen deliberately; a bar at the bottom of RG-Present reminds you it is there and takes it off again.

The browser is kept apart from the service on purpose: it has its own sandbox, it is refused the camera and microphone, and downloads are blocked. The open web cannot reach your library or your projector.

15. The optional helpers

RG-Present is complete without this, and it does nothing until you add a key of your own. If you have a Google account you can get a free Gemini API key at **aistudio.google.com** and paste it into **Settings → Gemini key**. Then **Ask** in the top bar (Ctrl + Shift + A) can:

- find a hymn you half remember — *from your own library*, with its number, never invented;
- suggest readings for a theme — it returns references, and your own Bible supplies the words;
- draft an order of service for you to edit;
- turn a page of notices into slides;

- generate a background picture from the theme of the service, if image generation is enabled on your Google account.

Nothing is sent anywhere until you ask a question, and the words that go on the screen always come from your own library and your own Bible. The key stays on your computer and can be deleted at any time. See the privacy policy on the website for the detail.

16. Settings worth knowing

SETTING	WHY YOU WOULD CHANGE IT
Audience output screen	The slides are on the wrong screen, or you have more than two.
Stage display screen	Which screen the musicians' display uses.
Default transition and fade length	A slower fade reads as calmer; **Cut** is instant.
Max lines per slide	Long verses are split into readable slides. Set it to 0 never to split.
Repeat the chorus after every verse	For congregations that sing it that way, without editing the hymn.
Text size on screen	A permanent setting for a small hall or a big one. A− and A+ change it for the moment.
Logo screen	The picture the L key shows.
Default Bible, verses per slide, reference size	How readings look and how much goes up at once.
Font for every slide	One font across themes that do not name their own. A theme's own font still wins.
Fallback fonts	So letters such as the Kimeru **ĩ** and **ũ** always draw correctly.

17. Keyboard shortcuts

These work whenever you are not typing in a box.

KEY	WHAT IT DOES
Space or →	Next slide
←	Previous slide
Enter	Send Preview to the screen
B	Black screen on or off
C	Hide the words, keep the background
L	Logo screen
R	Jump to the chorus
1 … 9	Jump to that verse or slide
]	Read on into the next verses
Esc	Take black, clear or logo off again
K / M	Pause a video / its sound on or off
+ / −	Words bigger or smaller on the screen
Ctrl + 0	Back to 100%
Ctrl + F	Jump to the library search box
Ctrl + K	Quick find: anything, by typing
Ctrl + M	Message across the screen
Ctrl + N / O / S / P	New, open, save, print the service
Ctrl + Shift + W	The web browser
Ctrl + Shift + A	Ask (needs a Gemini key)
F2	Rename the line you are on

18. Looking after your library

Where everything is kept

Your songs, services, media, imported Bibles and settings live in one folder: **%APPDATA%\RG-Present\data**. The quickest way there is **Settings → Data folder**, which opens it. Installing a new version never touches it.

Backing up

Copy that folder to a flash drive now and again — before a big service is a good habit. To move to a new machine, install RG-Present there and copy the folder across with RG-Present closed.

Settings → Export songs as pack... writes your own songs to a single file you can carry to another church machine and install there.

Updates

RG-Present checks quietly for a new version and never interrupts a service. When one has downloaded it is installed as you close the program. If the church machine has no internet, download the installer elsewhere and run it over the top: everything is kept.

If you installed from the Microsoft Store, the Store does the updating instead.

19. Coming from an older RG-Present

Install the new version straight over the old one. Your songs, saved services, imported Bibles, media and settings are all in the data folder, which the installer does not touch, so everything is where you left it when you open it again.

You do not need to uninstall first, and you should not delete the data folder if you are ever asked.

20. When something goes wrong

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
Your desktop is on the wall	Windows is duplicating rather than extending. **Windows** + **P**, then **Extend**.
The slides are on the laptop and the projector is blank	Press **Output** so its dot is green, then set the right screen under Settings.

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT TO DO
Nothing on the projector but black	The screen may be blacked. Press B, or Esc, and look at the Black, Clear and Logo buttons — a lit one is holding the screen.
The words are too small at the back	Press A+ a few times during the service, or set a bigger **Text size on screen** in Settings for good.
A verse is cut off at the bottom	Lower **Max lines per slide**, or give that song a theme with a smaller font.
Windows warns about the installer	Expected, and explained in section 2. **More info**, then **Run anyway** — or install from the Microsoft Store.
The projector shows the wrong shape	Set the projector to 16:9 in its own menu and make sure Windows is giving that screen its full resolution.
It will not start after a power cut	Open it again: your service is saved. If it still will not, email us before Sunday and say what the screen shows.

21. Getting help

Press F1 in RG-Present and this guide opens, from a copy kept on the computer, so it is there on a Sunday with no internet. The book button at the top right does the same, and Settings has the website, the privacy policy and the terms beside it.

Email rgdev.ke@gmail.com with what you were doing and what you saw. A photograph of the screen helps more than a description.

The website — overview, downloads, this guide, the privacy policy and the terms — is at **kenrodgersutugi-tech.github.io/rg-present-releases**.

RG-Present is made by RG Devs in Kenya. This guide covers version 1.8 and later.